What are some factors that might explain why a YouTube video with a high number of dislikes also has a high number of comments?

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Several factors could explain why a YouTube video receives both many dislikes and many comments:

- **Controversy encourages discussion.** Dislikes may signal that viewers strongly disagree with the video, prompting them to explain their objections, debate others, or defend the content. Research suggests controversial topics can generate conversation because they provoke stronger emotional reactions and interest pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov.
- **Dislikes can act as a cue that the video is contentious.** Viewers may see a high dislike count and become curious about the controversy, increasing the likelihood that they watch and comment.
- **Negative feedback does not necessarily mean disengagement.** People may dislike a video but still feel motivated to express their opinion. In one observational study of science videos, a tenfold increase in dislikes was associated with about a 66% increase in the rate of comments pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov.
- **Comments may include both criticism and support.** Controversial videos can attract opposing groups, leading to arguments, rebuttals, and defenders countering critics.
- **Popular videos have more opportunities for both reactions.** A video shown to a larger audience naturally has more chances to accumulate dislikes and comments. Other factors—such as views, recommendations, topic, and channel size—may contribute to both outcomes.
- **The relationship is correlational, not necessarily causal.** The evidence does not establish that dislikes directly cause comments. It may be that controversial content independently produces both negative ratings and discussion, or that comments and dislikes influence one another.

Thus, a high dislike count can be a sign not simply of rejection, but of **strong disagreement and active audience involvement**.

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